

Instructor Guide — Course 18: Professional Presence & Opportunity Building

Lesson 3: Showcase Your Work

Metadata

Field	Detail
Path	Digital Independence Path → Course 18: Professional Presence & Opportunity Building
Lesson	3 of course
Lesson Title	Showcase Your Work
Age Range	15–18
Format	Live, instructor-led (virtual classroom)
Duration	60 minutes
Tools	LinkedIn (16+; students under 16 use the portfolio-first alternative), Canva, Google Docs
Prerequisite	Course 16 case studies/projects completed and saved (Google Docs or Canva); Course 18 Lesson 1 (profile setup) and Lesson 2 (headline/about section) completed
Reusable Resource	Shared_Resources/Checklists/Portfolio_Review_Checklist.md

Overview

By this point, students have a working LinkedIn profile or portfolio-first presence page and have written at least one strong case study back in Course 16. This lesson is about connecting the two: taking their best project work and presenting it publicly in a way that a stranger — a recruiter, a mentor, a program reviewer — could understand and be impressed by in under 30 seconds.

The core skill is **curation**: choosing 2–3 strongest pieces of work rather than dumping everything, and writing a short, result-focused description for each. Students will add these as entries to the LinkedIn "Featured" section (or the "Projects" section of their portfolio page for under-16 students), then run the full lesson closer: the **Portfolio Review Checklist**, applied to their own profile/page as a final polish pass.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to: 1. Select their strongest 2–3 projects from their Course 16 case studies to feature publicly. 2. Write a title and a 1–2 sentence, result-focused description for each showcase entry. 3. Add showcase entries to the LinkedIn Featured section or their portfolio Projects section, each linked to supporting evidence (a doc, deck, image, or live link). 4. Run the Portfolio Review Checklist against their own profile/page and make at least two concrete edits based on it.

Materials & Prep (do before class)

- [] Confirm each student's Course 16 case study doc/deck is accessible (Google Drive share settings, Canva "anyone with link can view").
- [] Have your own demo LinkedIn profile (or a portfolio page mockup) ready with a fictional student's info loaded — see "Live Demo" below. Do not use a real student's account for the demo.
- [] Open [Shared_Resources/Checklists/Portfolio_Review_Checklist.md](#) and have it visible to share your screen from.
- [] Pre-load the Student Lesson and Worksheet for this lesson so you can screen-share the worked example.
- [] Test that Canva templates for "featured project" thumbnails (if you use one) are shared to the class Canva team/folder.
- [] Know which students in your section are under 16 (portfolio-first path) vs. 16+ (LinkedIn path) so you can pair the right demo/instructions to each breakout.

Teaching Sequence

Time	Segment	Instructor Notes
0:00–0:05	Welcome + framing	State the goal plainly: "Today you turn your best Course 16 project into something a stranger can find and understand in 30 seconds."
0:05–0:12	Mini-lesson: Curation over completeness	Deliver the "best work prominently, not everything" talking point (below). Show a bad example (10 tiny screenshots, no context) vs. a good example (2 strong entries, each with a title, outcome, and link).
0:12–0:20	Anatomy of a showcase entry	Break down the three parts: title, result-focused description, link. Show 2–3 real-feeling examples. Contrast a "process description" with a "result-focused description."
0:20–0:32	Live demo: adding a case study to a profile	Screen-share the full add-to-Featured (or add-to-Projects) flow using the fictional student (below). Narrate every click.
0:32–0:34	Transition to work time	Explain the worksheet: draft 2–3 showcase entries from their own Course 16 work.
0:34–0:48	Independent/paired work time	Students draft entries on the Worksheet, then add at least one live to their actual profile/page. Instructor circulates (see Troubleshooting).
0:48–0:56	Portfolio Review Checklist pass	Students open Portfolio_Review_Checklist.md and run it against their own profile/page. Instructor walks the group through the checklist section by section, pausing for

Time	Segment	Instructor Notes
		students to check items live.
0:56– 1:00	Discussion + close	Run 2 discussion questions aloud, assign reflection prompts, state submission instructions, close.

Talking Points: "Show Your Best Work Prominently, Not Everything"

Use these as spoken script anchors, not a script to read verbatim.

1. **The 30-second test.** "Nobody scrolls through 15 projects to find the good one. Whoever looks at your profile decides in the first few seconds whether to keep looking. Your job is to put your best 2–3 pieces of work where they can't be missed — not to prove you were busy."
2. **Featured ≠ archive.** "The Featured section (or your Projects section) is not a filing cabinet for everything you've ever made. It's closer to a store window. A store doesn't put every item it owns in the window — it puts the items most likely to make someone walk in."
3. **Quality signal, not quantity signal.** "Three strong entries with clear results tell someone 'this person finishes things and can explain them.' Ten weak entries tell someone 'this person didn't know what to leave out' — which is a worse signal, even though it's more work to produce."
4. **Context is the whole point.** "A screenshot with no caption tells a viewer nothing. 'Built a budgeting app that helped 12 beta testers track spending in one week' tells them everything: what you built, who it helped, and what changed. Context is not decoration — it's the actual content."

Live Demo Script: Adding a Case Study to a Fictional Student's Profile

Fictional student for the demo: *Amara Osei*, 17, completed a Course 16 case study titled "Track-It: A Study Habit Tracker for Teens," a mobile app mockup with a written case study covering problem, process, and outcome (12 beta testers used it over 2 weeks; 9 reported improved study consistency).

LinkedIn path (16+): 1. Open Amara's profile → click "Add profile section" → "Recommended" → "Add featured." 2. Choose "Add a link" (since the case study lives as a Google Doc with view access, or a Canva-exported PDF/link). 3. Paste the shareable link to the case study doc. LinkedIn auto-pulls a preview image and title — pause here and show students this can look wrong or generic, so it needs a fix. 4. Edit the custom title field to: **"Track-It — Study Habit Tracker (App Concept)"** 5. In the description field, add the result-focused description: **"Designed and mocked up a study-habit tracking app; tested with 12 peers over two weeks, with 9 reporting improved study consistency."** 6. Click "Save," then drag to reorder so this entry sits first/most prominent if Amara has more than one featured item. 7. Click "View as [public]" to confirm what a stranger actually sees, and check the link opens correctly in a new tab.

Portfolio-first path (under 16), Google Docs/Canva-built page: 1. Open Amara's portfolio page (a Google Doc formatted as a one-pager, or a Canva website/document). 2. Scroll to the "Projects" section. 3. Add a new entry block: Title → Description → "View Project" link (pointing to the shared Google Doc/Canva case study). 4. Same title

and description as above. 5. Set sharing permissions on the linked doc to "Anyone with the link can view" and test the link in an incognito/private window to confirm it's actually accessible to someone without edit rights.

Narrate while demoing: call out the difference between what you clicked and *why* — e.g., "I'm checking the public view because what I see as the owner is not what a stranger sees. This is the single most skipped step."

Anatomy of a Showcase Entry (for the mini-lesson)

Part	Purpose	Bad example	Good example
Title	Names the project and its type in a few words	"Project 3"	"Track-It — Study Habit Tracker (App Concept)"
Description (1–2 sentences)	States the outcome/result, not just what was done	"Made an app in Canva for my coding class."	"Designed and mocked up a study-habit tracking app; tested with 12 peers over two weeks, with 9 reporting improved study consistency."
Link	Sends the viewer to real evidence	No link, or a broken/private link	A tested, publicly viewable link to the case study doc or live project

Discussion Questions

1. "If you only had room to feature ONE project, which one would you choose from your Course 16 work, and why that one over the others?"
2. "Read your description out loud. Does it tell someone what changed or what result happened — or does it just describe what you did? What's one word you could cut?"

Common Misconceptions

Misconception 1: "I should show everything I've ever made." Reality check: More entries dilute attention rather than adding it. Coach students to rank their Course 16 projects and pick the top 2–3 by strength of outcome, not by how much time they spent. If a student insists on including a weak project, ask: "What does this one add that the other two don't already show?" If they can't answer, it stays out of Featured (they can still keep it in a private working folder).

Misconception 2: "Showcasing = just posting a screenshot with no context." Reality check: A screenshot alone answers "what does this look like" but not "why should I care." Every entry needs the title + result-focused description + link trio. If a student wants to post only an image, have them add the caption fields first — most platforms (LinkedIn Featured, Canva page blocks) support a title/description right alongside the image or link.

Anticipated Student Difficulties & Troubleshooting

Difficulty	What it looks like	Fix
Can't decide which project to feature	Student stalls, tries to feature all of them	Ask: "Which one has the clearest number or outcome attached?" Numbers (testers, time saved, users) make the decision concrete.
Description reads as a task list, not a result	"I used Canva and Google Docs to make a tracker app for my project."	Ask: "What happened because you made this? Who used it? What changed?" Rewrite together live.
Case study link is private/broken	Link opens to a "request access" page	Walk through sharing settings together: Google Docs → Share → "Anyone with the link" → Viewer. Canva → Share → "Anyone with the link can view."
LinkedIn auto-preview looks wrong (blank image, wrong title)	Featured entry looks broken or unbranded	Show them the manual title/description override fields — the auto-pull is a starting point, not the final version.
Under-16 student unsure their portfolio page is public-facing	Page is Google-Doc-shaped and feels private	Confirm sharing is set to "Anyone with the link – Viewer" and test the link in an incognito window together.
Student wants to skip the checklist because they "already did it right"	Rushes past the review pass	Require at least one item from the checklist to be checked live before moving on — most students find at least one fixable gap.

How to Review Student Work

Use [Shared_Resources/Checklists/Portfolio_Review_Checklist.md](#) as the review instrument for this lesson — do not write a separate rubric. During the 0:48–0:56 block, walk the checklist section by section as a group, then during independent grading/spot-checks, confirm for each student:

- At least one Course 16 project is added as a showcase entry (LinkedIn Featured or portfolio Projects section).
- The entry has a title, a result-focused (not task-focused) description of 1–2 sentences, and a working, publicly viewable link.
- The student ran the Portfolio Review Checklist against their own profile/page and can name at least two specific edits they made as a result — vague answers like "it looked fine" mean the checklist wasn't actually applied and should be redone with you watching.

Lesson Close

Recap in one sentence: "You just turned a project you already finished into proof that a stranger can find and understand." Confirm submission instructions (see Student Lesson) and preview Lesson 4's focus if applicable (expanding reach/network based on this presence). Thank the group and end.